

Fixing Comma Splices — 9th Grade, 30 Minutes

Diagnose & Repair — Comma Splices

The Cover Test: Cover everything after the comma. Complete sentence? Cover everything before. Complete sentence too? That's a comma splice. Fix it with: a **conjunction** (and, but, so, yet), a **semicolon**, or a **period**.

Items 1–3: Label and fix each comma splice. Write your repair on the lines below each sentence.

1. The cafeteria ran out of pizza, everyone was disappointed.

Is this a splice? (circle) YES NO

Fix it using a conjunction:

2. She finished the lab report in twenty minutes, her partner was still on page one.

Is this a splice? (circle) YES NO

Fix it using a semicolon:

3. The power went out during the storm, no one could see the board.

Is this a splice? (circle) YES NO

Fix it using a period (rewrite as two sentences):

Items 4–5: Work on your own.

4. One of these sentences has a comma splice and one does not. Circle the splice, then fix it.

A. I wanted to leave early, the movie was already over.

B. I wanted to leave early, but the movie wasn't over yet.

Fix the splice here:

5. Look back at what you wrote for the class starter. Copy one sentence below. If it has a comma splice, fix it. If it doesn't, rewrite it so it does — then fix that version too.

Your sentence:

Your fix:

Exit ticket: what a comma splice is and how to fix it

In your own words, explain what a comma splice is and how to fix it. Write it the way you would explain it to someone who missed class today — not the definition you were given, but what you actually understand it to mean.

Write as much as you can, and go further than your first sentence — the more you explain your thinking, the more this is worth. Don't worry about polish. This is about what you understand, not how neatly you say it.